



Troubling times: In 2023, esteemed wrestlers like three-time World medallist Bajrang, two-time World medallist Vinesh Phogat, and the sole women's wrestling world champion Sakshi Malik took to the streets, levelling serious allegations of sexual misconduct against the then WFI president Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh.

R. V. MOORTHY

the senior world championships in 2019. Ravi Dahiya, who won a silver medal at the Tokyo Olympics, is also uncertain for the Paris Games. Ravi was himself eliminated early in the selection trials for the World Championships and subsequently underwent knee surgery that kept him out of the Hangzhou Asian Games.

In Ravi's absence, the spot on the Indian roster in the 57kg category has been claimed by Aman Sehrawat, who trains alongside him

WRESTLERS IN INDIA DEMANDED THE ARREST OF THE WFI CHIEF FOR ALLEGED SEXUAL HARASSMENT OF FEMALE WRESTLERS

at New Delhi's Chhatrasal stadium.

Aman won gold at last year's Asian Championships and only suffered a narrow loss in the semifinals of the Asian Games. Although Aman hasn't qualified for the Olympics after losing early at the World Championships in 2023, he will back himself to do so. This, of course, is premised on Aman beating Ravi at the selection trials that will be held early in 2024. In Aman's favour is the fact that he is in top form, winning the Zagreb ranking series,

the first tournament in the international wrestling calendar for 2024. Ravi, though, has never lost to Aman and will believe he has it in him to add to his Olympic medal tally.

With a couple of world-class contenders still in the mix, Indian wrestling can return with a respectable performance in Paris. However, unless the issues with the federation are dealt with, any results will only be papering over the underlying chaos.